

they were only following orders and not making decisions on their own. Retainers may be awarded more than their agreed upon portion of the treasure and thus gain more experience than normal. Retainer's earned experience is adjusted by character class adjustments due to their abilities (see page B7).

### Traps

Dungeons often contain traps, such as a trap door in the floor which springs open when a character walks over it. If any character does something which could trigger a trap (such as walking over a certain point), the trap will be sprung on a roll of 1-2 (on 1d6). The DM must check for each character passing the spot until the trap is either sprung or safely passed by all. Trap damage is usually automatic once sprung, and traps are not considered part of combat. Monsters may either have the same chances as characters, or might never spring traps; the choice is left to the DM.

Any character has a 1 in 6 chance of finding a trap when searching for one in the correct area. Any dwarf has a 2 in 6 chance. (This does *not* apply to magical traps, such as a **sleep** trap.) Checking a specific area for a trap will take one full turn. The DM should *only* check for finding a trap if a player says that the character is searching for one. Each character may only check once to find each trap.

### Wandering Monsters

Wandering monsters are monsters which roam through dungeons but have not been placed in rooms by the DM. Wandering monsters may be selected by the DM to fit each dungeon (for example, a guard of skeletons might patrol a tomb). The DM may choose wandering monsters at random by using the **Wandering Monsters** tables in **Part 8: DUNGEON MASTER INFORMATION** (pages B53-54).

## GIVING EXPERIENCE POINTS

When the adventure is over, the DM gives experience points to the surviving characters. Experience points (abbreviated XP, as ep stands for electrum pieces) are given for non-magical treasure and for defeating monsters. For every 1 gp value of non-magical treasure the characters recover, the DM should give 1 XP to the party (this will be divided among all the player characters). Experience points are not given for magic items. The characters will divide the treasure among themselves, but the DM handles all the experience. **EXAMPLE:** A treasure of 750 sp, a rug worth 100 gp, 3 gems each worth 100 gp, and a **potion of healing** would be worth a total of 475 XP (75 + 100 + 300 + 0).

Experience points are also given for monsters killed or overcome by magic, fighting, or wits. Use the **Experience Points for Monsters** table (below) to determine how many points to give the party.

1. Find the number equal to a monster's hit dice to determine the base amount of XP to award for one monster: Note that any "+" to the hit dice counts the same (3 + 1 gives the same XP as 3 + 2, and so forth).
2. Add the special abilities bonus *once for each asterisk* after "hit dice" in the monster description (for example, a medusa with 4\*\* hit dice would be worth 175 XP: 75 base + 50 special + 50 special).
3. Multiply this total XP value by the number of monsters overcome to find the grand total to be awarded for that encounter (if 3 medusae were overcome, 525 XP would be awarded: 175 × 3).

## EXPERIENCE POINTS FOR MONSTERS

| Monster's Hit Dice | Base Value | Special Abilities Bonus |
|--------------------|------------|-------------------------|
| Under 1            | 5          | 1                       |
| 1                  | 10         | 3                       |
| 1 +                | 15         | 4                       |
| 2                  | 20         | 5                       |
| 2 +                | 25         | 10                      |
| 3                  | 35         | 15                      |
| 3 +                | 50         | 25                      |
| 4                  | 75         | 50                      |
| 4 +                | 125        | 75                      |
| 5                  | 175        | 125                     |
| 5 +                | 225        | 175                     |
| 6                  | 275        | 225                     |

**ADJUSTMENTS TO XP:** The DM may treat an unusually "tough" situation or monster as one category better (use the next line down). Situations might also allow the DM to give partial experience if the characters learned from the encounter without actually defeating the monster. The DM may also award extra XP to characters who deserve them (fighting a dangerous monster alone, or saving the party with a great idea), and less XP to characters who did less than their fair share ("do-nothing" characters). The DM should consider the character's alignment and class carefully, and should remember that guarding the rear is an important role in any party.

**DIVIDING XP:** **Treasure** is divided by the party, but the DM handles all the **XP** awards. At the end of an adventure, the DM totals the XP from all treasures recovered plus all monsters defeated and then divides the total by the number of surviving characters (both player characters and NPCs) in the party. **EXAMPLE:** A party of 7 (5 player characters and 2 NPCs) goes on an adventure but only 6 come back alive. They killed monsters for a total of 800 XP and also collected 5800 gp in treasure, for a total of 6600 XP. Each character receives 1100 XP at the end of the adventure. (The DM may give each NPC ½ normal experience — 550 XP in this case — since the NPCs were "directed" and thus benefit less from the adventure.)

**BONUSES TO XP:** Remember that characters with high scores in their prime requisites gain a bonus of XP. In the example above, a fighter with 16 strength would receive a total of 1210 XP (1100 + 110) instead of 1100 XP.

**MAXIMUM XP:** A character should never be given enough XP in a single adventure to advance more than one level of experience. For example, if a beginning (0 XP) 1st level fighter earns 5000 XP (a rare and outstanding achievement), he or she should only be given 3999 XP, enough to place the character 1 XP short of 3rd level.

Every time a character goes up in level, the player must roll a new hit die, make any adjustments due to constitution (if applicable), and add the result to the previous number of hit points. A character may not go up in level until after an adventure is over, when XP are awarded by the DM.

**EXAMPLE:** Bork, a 2nd level fighter with 3000 XP, gains 1210 XP on an adventure, giving him a total of 4210 XP (over 4001, the amount needed to become 3rd level). Bork has 11 hp and a Constitution score of 15 (+1 bonus). When Bork returns from the adventure the player rolls 1d8; the result of 5 is adjusted to 6, and added to the previous 11 hp for a new total of 17 hp. Bork notes these figures on his sheet, along with the note that he is now a 3rd level fighter.